

The GenTech Retention Strategy

Author: Joy Lorna

Tools Used: Microsoft Excel, PowerPoint

Dataset: HR Analytics (Fictionalized Case Study)

1. Executive Summary

GenTech Solutions, a leading technology firm, faced a critical "leaky bucket" in its talent pipeline, specifically regarding 12-month retention rates. This analysis investigated generational trends to determine if a "one-size-fits-all" HR policy was contributing to high turnover. The findings revealed a severe retention cliff for **Generation Z (13.7 months average tenure)** and **Millennials**, particularly in technical roles. This report provides a data-driven roadmap to stabilize the workforce through milestone-based interventions and targeted mentorship.

2. Business Problem & Objectives

The leadership at GenTech suspected that different generational cohorts (Baby Boomers, Gen X, Millennials, and Gen Z) had divergent workplace needs that were not being met, leading to fluctuating turnover.

Primary Objectives:

- Segment the workforce into generational cohorts to analyze tenure and exit patterns.
 - Identify "Danger Zone" departments where turnover is significantly higher than the company average.
 - Evaluate the ROI of training investments against employee lifecycle length.
 - Propose actionable, generation-specific HR strategies to improve retention.
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3. Methodology (The Technical Process)

To conduct this analysis, I performed the following steps in Excel:

- **Data Cleaning:** Standardized department names, handled missing values, and validated performance scores for 1,886 employee records.
 - **Feature Engineering:** * Created a **Generation** column using **IFS** logic based on age.
 - Developed **Tenure Buckets** (0-6m, 7-12m, 13-24m, 24m+) to identify the specific timing of exits.
 - Calculated **Average Training Costs** per cohort to measure investment risk.
 - **Data Analysis:** Utilized Pivot Tables to cross-analyze tenure against Gender, Department, and Performance ratings.
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4. Key Findings

- **The 12-Month Cliff:** Generation Z has the shortest average tenure (**13.7 months**). The "Leaky Bucket" tenure category (7-12 months) is most densely populated by Gen Z and Millennials.
 - **Technical Talent Drain: Software Engineering** is the highest-risk department for Gen Z, with an average tenure of only **12.0 months**.
 - **The Investment Gap:** GenTech spends approximately **\$561 per employee** on training regardless of age. Because Gen Z stays 5 months less than Baby Boomers, the company is losing significant ROI on younger hires.
 - **Leadership Anchors:** Baby Boomers provide organizational stability in **Executive and Admin roles**, with tenures exceeding **27 months**.
 - **Performance Insight:** Gen Z represents a high volume of "Strong Performers" (82 exits), indicating that GenTech is losing its top future talent prematurely.
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5. Strategic Recommendations

- **Introduce 10-Month Milestones:** Implement a "Junior Developer II" title or a retention bonus at the 10-month mark specifically for technical roles to push Gen Z past the 12-month exit cliff.
- **Reverse Mentorship:** Pair long-tenured Baby Boomers in Executive roles with Gen Z new hires to increase engagement and institutional knowledge transfer.
- **Phased Training Budget:** Instead of front-loading training costs, spread the \$561 budget over 18 months, unlocking advanced certifications at the 14-month mark as a "stay" incentive.

- **Internal Mobility for Millennials:** Offer Millennial employees (the highest volume of exits) the opportunity for departmental rotations to prevent mid-career stagnation.
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6. Project Assets

- **Excel Workbook:** Contains raw data, cleaning steps, and the interactive analysis dashboard.
- **Strategic Presentation:** A high-level summary of findings and the "GenTech 2026 Roadmap" for HR leadership.